



Cold Email Templates (With Explanations)

Thanks for downloading the templates! Each of the nine templates come with explanations on why we wrote them the way we did. These emails are proven to work, so copy/paste at your leisure :)

If you want to see all the cold email tips, [head on back to the guide](#).

Email 1: The lunch meeting email (aka cold email)

SUBJECT: Example Use Template Hey Noah, yes another taco-related email

MESSAGE:

Hey Noah,

I wasn't sure which Tacodeli is closest to you, so I guessed Central. They've got a gift card waiting for you behind the counter, in your name.

Love to take you out to your favorite lunch to discuss making AppSumo better.

How's next Friday at 11:30pm at La Condessa?

Be amazing,

Joey

-----another version-----

I am a HUGE fan of AppSumo.

Bought the Sumo Business Blueprint and Piktochart.

Do you mind if I ask you 1 simple question?

Be well,

Noah

Story

There is no perfect solution to a coffee / lunch meeting email. If there was then you wouldn't need a template. I've sent hundreds and received hundreds regarding this.

The key thing is relevancy and major benefit for the recipient.

Here's an email I got today:

"I may soon take another trip and I would like to pass through Austin if you are willing to meet for lunch. At this point I'm not sure if I'll be going through Texas...when I start my drive...if my timing is convenient for you. Can you meet at your convenience? A personal meeting. I'm thinking we can try Taco Deli and I'll let you know how it compares with fav - Chronic Taco, a SoCal Baja Mexican food chain with amazing burritos."

What do you think my response was? Exactly, it's in the how to reject these emails template :)

What's in it for me with that email?

I eat lunch everyday but I can afford my own and would prefer not to have my brain picked while eating.

Yes, this is how the recipient feels when you send them something like this.

So what can you do?

- Make it extremely relevant.
- Minimize the investment / commitment needed by the recipient. HUGE difference to ask someone for breakfast vs answering 1 simple question via email.
- Think of your recipient like a hot person at a bar. They get asked out a lot, how are you going to stand out?

Bonus tips:

- You have to stand out. Send a card, Fedex, post-card, etc.

- Really emphasize why this is worth THEIR time, not yours. I.e. highlight things about their biz they may not be aware of.
- I've found time and time again it is 10000x better to get an introduction via a cold email. See on LinkedIn / FB if anyone knows the person you want to connect with.
- Keep it short. I know people know this but for some reason NO ONE does this.
- Everyone does breakfast / lunch. Keep your asks LIGHT. Phone calls are annoying to most. Try to stick with email and only request phone-calls / in-person meeting if absolutely necessary. A heavy ask is getting the person to do something for you, a great light ask is 1 simple like "do you like tacos or burritos." A heavier example could be why do you do the business you do or what is the meaning of life.
- ALWAYS follow up your chat with a relevant thank you gift.
- I hate to remind you but if YOU are asking someone for coffee / lunch then YOU pay.

Email 2: Cold email (no response)

SUBJECT: Checking In :)

MESSAGE:

Hey Mate,

Hope you had an amazing weekend.

Wanted to see what your team thought of my suggestions...

Be awesome.

--Noah

-----Option 2:-----

Leslie,

Definitely excited to help you grow your business.

Love to help close things out by Friday if possible.

--Noah

Story

The highest response rates I've gotten are when I'm NOT super annoying and make it easy for someone to respond to me.

Short and sweet and more persistent checking in will help you vs a long-diatribes. This is a great time to be using FollowUp.cc and ensure you don't forget to follow up.

A key thing to aim for is to try and find why they aren't responding, what their KEY problems actually are (you may not be helping with that) or why they don't like you.

Email 3: Get a contract back ASAP

SUBJECT: Contract attached - action required

MESSAGE:

Hey Steven,

Really looking forward to working together!

Attached is our agreement.

To keep things moving forward, can you get this back to me by Friday at 3pm?

Looking forward to it!

--Noah

Story

So many times have I thought a deal was "complete." Quickly did I realize there needs to be an agreement in place.

It is a crappy feeling to send the agreement and wait anxiously for a reply.

Before you even think of emailing see if you can meet in person to get the document signed. This is better than any email.

If that doesn't work then try docusign.com or echosign.com so you can have them sign it electronically and conveniently.

Use one of my two secret tricks: Friday@followup.cc in the CC line. This will include a reminder to them on Friday. Also, add a calendar invite so they have a deadline to get the agreement back to you.

Email 4: The \$500,000 email

SUBJECT: 15 minutes...

MESSAGE:

What size shoe?

What day / time next week?

Thanks.

Noah

Story

This was an email thread with a potential partner. I stalked him on Facebook and found out he loved running. Then I proposed a 15-minute meeting with him in exchange for a pair of any running shoes he wanted.

It was short, sweet and to the point. AND made us a nice \$500,000 profit over the next year...Definitely worth the \$100 shoes I bought him.

Here's the response I got from this email (results may vary):

Hey, let's do next Fri 2/20 6-6:15pm

Our office is at 840 Battery St

Shoe size 10.5D

Best,

G

Email 5: Cold email to prospect

SUBJECT 1: Oh no, a cold email for Steven

SUBJECT 2: Increasing AppSumo's revenues by 50%

MESSAGE:

Hey Steven,

I saw you on Yelp and was impressed by your 4-star rating for home care.

We help home care businesses increase revenue by 50%.

Love to send you our top 10 ways to do that.

Is this the best mailing address for you?

522 e. 6th Street

2nd Floor

Austin, TX 78701

Sincerely,

John Deere

Story

I've sent thousands of emails to cold and warm leads. What is a KEY thing to highlight is ensuring your subject line relates immediately to the specific thing you'll do to help their business.

It is okay to keep the subject line generic instead of over-promising which may seem too far-fetched. Try both out and see what works better for you. Personally, I've found saying something more actionable / tangible gets a higher response rate.

Make it something quantifiable and relevant. A template generic message will decrease your response rate.

Email 6: Reply to a deal being accepted

SUBJECT:
Awesome sauce!

MESSAGE:

Steven,

That is great news! You are in good hands.

Let's setup a meeting in person this Tuesday at 8am.

I'll bring the paper work to your office and we can discuss next steps

Have an amazing day,

--Noah

Story

Momentum momentum momentum.

It is depressing to think through all the times a deal has closed but something got in the way.

You want to clearly reinforce what they are doing is a positive action.

If you can go in person with the agreement, I would highly recommend doing that. I've experienced numerous times that it's harder for them to say no or change their mind to your face.

Following that, encourage a near-term deadline to ensure there is no buyer's remorse and the deal is moving forward.

Definitely consider using echosign / docuSign so they can digitally sign the agreement as quickly as possible.

Also, I try to get whatever work we've agreed on happening in parallel even at the risk the agreement falls through. This helps motivate the partner to continue forward.

Email 7: Reply to being turned down

SUBJECT:

Steven, I need your help

MESSAGE:

Hey Steven,

Thanks for taking the time to respond.

What could I have done to win your business?

I know you are busy but any guidance will vastly help me improve!

Be amazing,

Noah

Ps. Mind if I touch base in 2 months?

Story

BIG RED FLAG. DO NOT just keep selling. I've had companies add me to the mailing list and continue to keep pitching.

This makes them even less likely to respond and subsequently create a Gmail filter to never hear from them again.

The main points with this email are:

- Reconfirm a time you can follow up.
- Try to really understand their highest priorities not just what you are pitching.
- Acknowledge and genuinely appreciate them emailing you back.
- If you ask, most people will gladly help you, help them if you phrase it politely.

Expect around ~40% response rate from this email.

Email 8: How to get a Biz-Dev Deal

SUBJECT:

Pimping Backblaze to 730,000+ entrepreneurs

MESSAGE:

Hey Gleb,

Been hearing killer things about Backblaze recently and I had to reach out :-)

AppSumo is always on the hunt for the best tools to promote to our huge list of sumo-lings, and Backblaze looks boss.

*Here is some more info on our reach, our customers, and who we've worked with in the past:
<http://www.appsumo.com/partners/>*

Would love to chat about how we can make something exciting happen. What do you think?

Cheers,

Anton

Variation #2

Hey Andrew,

Been hearing killer things about Safari Books Online lately and I just had to reach out :-)

AppSumo is hand selecting a few stellar products to feature in October and we would love to showcase Safari Books Online to over 730,000+ potential new customers.

When we asked our customers if they'd be interested in a product like yours, we got a huge resounding "yes!". I think they would make for great lifetime Safari Books Online customers.

*Here is some more info on our reach, our customers, and who we've worked with in the past:
<http://www.appsumo.com/partners/>*

Please email me by the 30th and we'll make it happen.

Cheers,

Anton

Story

The key thing to note and do is how do you make your email a NO brainer.

The subject line must be appealing and completely beneficial to them. In this example there is a clear and relevant proposition that the people at BackBlaze want.

Legitimacy is huge. Anyone popular gets contacted frequently so social proof is necessary to show you are a real "player."

Most companies love their customers so if you can tie in how your customers are salivating and talking about them it lubricates an easier conversation. Bonus point if you can be specific. Companies have a HUGE list of priorities they are committed to. Getting a random email trying to insert yourself is hard.

1. You need to understand what the priorities of the other business are before you try to biz-dev / sale / partner with them. Please consider you may make the WRONG assumption about what their priorities are so if you get rejected try to focus on what IS important to them, not just what you want to offer.
2. You must focus on the relationship, even if the partnership isn't as immediate. When I tried to get a deal with Zynga, I spent over a year nurturing that relationship.
3. You MUST show proof / value that you are worth their time to even consider chatting with you.

I've seen at least a 15% increase in response rates from adding a time-sensitive call to action at the end, "email me back by...".

Email 9: Reaching out to fans on Facebook pages

MESSAGE:

Hey Gloria

I see that you're a fan of Victoria Secrets, me too!

We're creating a new lingerie product with the curvaceous woman in mind and would love to have you get one of our first products, complimentary.

Please check out our page with pictures here: [Link to product / fan-page](#)

Let me know if you'd like one...

Stay awesome :)

Jimmy Johns

Story

While doing guerrilla marketing I've needed to find new customers or get validation on a new idea.

Here's a very effective Facebook message you can send to anyone and get a really great response.

The KEY things to include:

- Give a benefit for the person to check out your link.
- Include your full name.
- Use a fun tagline instead of something stodgy (or none at all). The Stay gorgeous is fun and quirky.
- Don't send the same message over and over otherwise you'll go to the other inbox (Facebook's way of preventing spam).

- Be personal. Reference one thing about the person.
- Asking for broad feedback, gets you broad results. Be specific with what you want and ask. (ie. i want to get you an early version of it or wanted to see if you like our colors.)